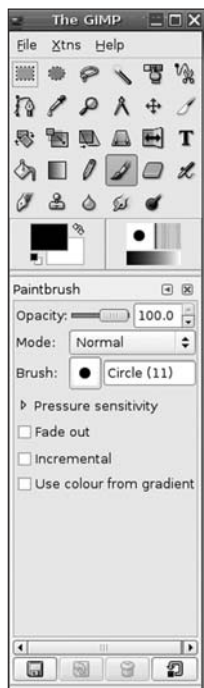


GTK+ is a platform used to write applications for the X Server. GTK+ is free and part of the GNU Project. With the licensing terms for GTK+, it is legal for all developers to include those developing proprietary software, without any license fees or royalties. GTK+ is based on three libraries called GLib, Pango and ATK, each of which is used to perform specific functions when developing X clients.

The current version of the GNOME Desktop is 2.12, in which work has been done to make it easier to port GNOME tools to Windows as well. This version is available as a Live CD, whose image can be downloaded using BitTorrent (<http://torrent.gnome.org>).

Corporate support for GNOME comes from big names such as HP, IBM, Novell, Red Hat and Sun Microsystems, among others. Among the major distributions, SuSE and one of the hot newer Linux distributions, Ubuntu, uses GNOME as the default desktop environment. Gentoo is another distribution that comes with GNOME. Fedora, Mandriva and others give an option to install GNOME, though the default is KDE.



Various tools in GIMP

4.1.3.3 The KDE vs. GNOME battle!

When there are two things of the same kind, there is bound to be a competition. Especially so if both are nearly as good as each other! We have told you *about* KDE and GNOME, but what really sets them apart? Is it possible to say which is actually better?

KDE and GNOME belong to the same era, with the former being founded in 1996 and the latter, a year later in '97. KDE has been coded with the object-oriented C++, while GNOME stuck to the more conservative C.